

Man in the Box (Rhythm Guitar) -- Alice In Chains

From *Facelift* (1990). About 108 BPM, est.

A sludgy, grinding riff with Jerry Cantrell's famous talk-box line, a wah-drenched solo, and a heavy, droning chorus.

As far as I know, the band tuned down a half step on this era of material. Tune to Eb standard to match the record.

The GP-5 has no talk box. CTL uses the Toucher envelope filter, which gives a touch-driven vowel sweep. It's the closest stand-in, and it doubles as the wah for the solo.

Built from the song's overall sound. I haven't verified the exact guitars and amps on the record.

Instrument: Stratocaster (HSS). Bridge humbucker throughout.

GP-5 only, Stratocaster (HSS), no pedalboard.

AMP: UK 800 (JCM800) + CAB: V30112 IR (User IR 10)

A JCM800 with a boost in front is the late-80s and early-90s heavy Seattle foundation: thick, grinding, mid-heavy. It's not scooped metal.

V30112 is the loaded guitar cab with enough upper-mid bark for a crunch tone. EVM112 would thin out once the amp breaks up.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 45.

High gain plus a tube-screamer boost is noisy. 45 keeps the riff stops dead silent.

PRE -- Toucher (envelope filter), on CTL.

Sense: 60, Range: 55, Q: 65, Mix: 70, Mode: Guitar.

The talk-box and wah stand-in. The Toucher envelope filter at a high Q of 65 gives a vowel-like "wow" that follows your pick attack. Dig in for a bigger sweep. Mode: Guitar.

DST -- Green OD (TS-808), always on.

Gain: 20, Tone: 45, VOL: 70.

An always-on TS boost, low gain and high level. It tightens and pushes the 800 for the grinding Seattle chunk.

AMP -- UK 800, always on.

Gain: 68, PRES: 50, VOL: 58, Bass: 55, Middle: 62, Treble: 52.

Gain 68 is thick and heavy. Middle 62: this sound is mid-heavy sludge, not scooped.

CAB -- User IR 10 (V30112), always on.

VOL: 60.

EQ -- Guitar EQ 2, always on.

100Hz: 0, 500Hz: +1, 1kHz: +1, 3kHz: 0, 6kHz: -3, VOL: 50.

Mid push for grind. -3 at 6kHz for dark, sludgy fizz control.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- Analog, on CTL.

Mix: 14, Time: 330ms, F.Back: 20, Trail: on.

A short tail under the talk-box line and the solo.

RVB -- Room, always on.

Mix: 10, Decay: 25, Trail: on.

Mostly dry and heavy.

CTL footswitch

On CTL: PRE (Toucher), DLY (Analog).

- **CTL off** -- Rhythm. A boosted JCM800 sludge grind for the riff, the verses, and the chorus drone. This is the resting state the patch loads into.

- **CTL on** -- Talk box and lead. The envelope-filter vowel sweep plus a short tail for the "talk box" riff line and the wah solo.

Engage CTL for the talk-box riff sections and the solo. Off for the grinding rhythm.